Exam-day checklist

Understand it

On exam day, strategy matters as much as knowledge. Know what you will do when a question is hard, when you miss an answer, and when time is short.

The computer test lets you highlight, make notes and move between questions. Use these tools the way you practised.

The rules

- Read the question and the word limit before the audio starts. Underline key words.
- Listening: answers come in order. If you miss one, leave it and keep up; come back only at the end.
- Reading: about 20 minutes per passage. Do not spend more than 90 seconds on one question.
- Never leave a blank: a guess costs nothing. Check spelling and singular / plural in the last two minutes.

All the words and forms you need

Listening	read ahead · underline key words · follow the order · never stop on one gap · check plurals and spelling in the final minutes
Reading	about 20 minutes per passage · questions first · skim · scan for names and numbers · highlight proof · guess if needed
Writing	Task 2 first if you prefer · 40 minutes Task 2, 20 minutes Task 1 · plan 5 minutes · check 3 minutes
Speaking	extend · give examples · ask to repeat if needed: Could you repeat the question, please?

Where you use it

Reading: Skim, then find keywords. Use highlighting on the computer.

Listening: No replay: keep calm and move on.

Writing: Plan for 5 minutes, write, check for 3 minutes.

Speaking: Speak slowly and extend each answer.

More examples

- Could you say that again, please?
- That's an interesting question; let me think for a second.
- I'm not sure, but I'd guess that ...
- Overall, ...

Common mistakes

WRONG	RIGHT
✗ Stopping to think about one hard answer.	✓ Move on and come back.
✗ Leaving a blank.	✓ Guess.
✗ Forgetting the word limit.	✓ Check it every time.

Speaking practice: answer using this grammar

1. Practise: answer one Part 3 question after saying 'That's an interesting question.'
2. Ask the examiner to repeat a question politely.
3. Give a 2-minute talk without stopping.

Writing practice

Write your personal exam-day checklist (10 points).

Practice

1. How long per Reading passage?

2. What do you do if you miss an answer in Listening?

3. What is the maximum time on one question?

4. Do you leave blanks?

5. What do you check in the last two minutes?

6. What do you do before the audio starts?

Answers

1. About 20 minutes.
2. Leave it and keep up.
3. About 90 seconds.
4. No, guess.
5. Spelling and singular / plural.
6. Read the questions and underline key words.